

Do You Really Need a CPA Anymore?

Why modern organizations are rethinking financial operations.

A research-driven briefing on technology, stewardship, and the future of financial visibility for churches and mission-driven organizations.

3 minute read | PDF available | Shareable briefing

84% positive signal Tax and accounting professionals surveyed in Thomson Reuters coverage increasingly view AI as a beneficial tool.	93% advisory lift Intuit QuickBooks survey respondents reported using AI to enhance strategic advisory work, summaries, and insights.	80%+ weekly usage Recent professional-services research shows most GenAI users are making it part of weekly work rhythms.
---	--	--

Financial operations are becoming systemized.

For decades, organizations depended on traditional accounting structures because financial information was difficult to access, reporting was manual, and accounting expertise was concentrated in a small number of specialists.

Today, that landscape is changing rapidly. Leading accounting firms, software providers, and financial institutions are investing heavily in automation, AI-assisted workflows, connected financial systems, real-time reporting, and operational visibility.

The question is no longer, Should technology support accounting? The question is, How much of traditional financial operations can now be systemized?

AI-assisted financial workflows are becoming standard across the industry.	Real-time visibility is replacing delayed reporting cycles.	Human-in-the-loop verification is becoming a core operating principle.
--	---	--

The value is shifting from assembly to interpretation.

Historically, organizations paid for specialized knowledge, compliance confidence, financial review, reporting accuracy, and operational trust. Those functions still matter.

But technology is reducing the amount of manual labor required to produce that confidence. Modern systems can now help automate categorization, reconciliation, reporting assembly, dashboard visibility, workflow management, financial organization, and operational reporting.

Organizations are increasingly paying for interpretation and oversight, not manual assembly.

The future is not less wisdom. It is allowing wisdom to move faster.

The future is not no CPA.

The future is automation for repetitive work, experienced operators for interpretation, and CPA-level expertise where complexity truly requires it.

For many churches and mission-driven organizations, the practical need is not a larger internal finance department. It is a cleaner operating system for financial visibility, monthly rhythm, payroll infrastructure, and leadership reporting.

The best model is not software alone. It is a unified financial operating layer with judgment built in.

04 WHY WE BUILT ALIGNED INSIGHTS

Technology should remove obstacles from the mission.

At Aligned Insights, our team brings more than 30 years of combined experience across ministry, operations, systems, finance, and technology.

We are believers first. We believe technology should help organizations move further, faster, not create more complexity.

Churches and nonprofits should not have to choose between operational excellence and ministry focus.

Modern financial systems can help organizations gain visibility faster, reduce operational friction, improve stewardship, simplify reporting, support leadership decisions, spend less time chasing information, and spend more time serving people.

Technology is not the mission. But when used wisely, it can remove obstacles that slow the mission down.

Cleaner reporting	Stronger visibility	Healthier monthly rhythm
-------------------	---------------------	--------------------------

What ministry leaders are experiencing

Ryan Coggins and the team at Aligned Insights helped simplify what had become unnecessarily complicated for our organization. As our church continued to grow, we needed cleaner systems, clearer reporting, and better operational visibility without building a massive internal finance department.

Through automation, improved systems, and operational visibility, Aligned Insights helped Life Church reduce an estimated \$150,000+ per year in operational overhead while creating a smoother and healthier operational rhythm across our organization.

What stood out was their understanding of both ministry and operations. They helped create clearer reporting, healthier workflows, and more confidence in the decisions we were making as a leadership team so our staff could spend less time managing operational complexity and more time focused on people and ministry.

Aaron Cole

Senior Pastor

Life Church Wisconsin

<https://www.lifechurchwi.com/germantown>

Clarity is becoming the advantage.

The future does not belong to organizations with the largest finance departments. It belongs to organizations with the clearest visibility, the healthiest systems, and the fastest ability to make wise decisions.

Request a Free Financial Insights Report

See how modern financial systems could improve visibility, reporting, and operational clarity inside your organization.

REFERENCES

Research signals behind the briefing.

CPA.com

2025 AI in Accounting Report and CPA.com AI in Accounting resources
<https://www.cpa.com/news/cpacom-issues-2025-ai-accounting-report>

Thomson Reuters

Future of Professionals Report 2024 and professional-services AI research
<https://www.thomsonreuters.com/en-us/posts/technology/future-of-professionals-2024/>

Intuit QuickBooks

2025 QuickBooks Accountant Technology Survey
<https://investors.intuit.com/news-events/press-releases/detail/1263/accountants-embrace-ai-and-strategic-advisory-services-to-fuel-growth-yet-continue-to-face-tech-and-talent-barriers-according-to-2025-intuit-quickbooks-survey>

Deloitte

Generative AI in Finance Transformation
<https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/what-we-do/capabilities/finance-transformation/articles/generative-ai-in-finance-transformation.html>

EY

Digital finance and finance-transformation research
https://www.ey.com/en_us/services/consulting/finance-consulting-services/how-ai-is-transforming-financial-planning-and-analysis

PwC

Finance modernization and finance transformation research
<https://www.pwc.com/us/en/services/consulting/business-transformation/library/controller-finance-modernization.html>